

WEEK 2 – LEARNING TO SPEND

“We want the finest wines available to humanity. And we want them here, and we want them now”

- Withnail / Richard E Grant in *Withnail & I* (1986)

As I huddled with the boys by the corner curb at the intersection of Lamar and Cesar Chavez, it was the time of Austin City Limits: the biggest music festival in the ‘World Capital of Music’. The sun dripped into the horizon, looking over the shoulder, the lineup of musicians and singers summed up to 50 for the day; imagine 50 different bands in one day. As darkness slowly dawned, Austin strode into its vibe: the constant yell, the tears of joy, pizzas smattered around the street, laying atop the crumbled tacos, hippies, wannabe musicians drinking themselves to death, UT students drinking and vomiting in spray forms, bats flying across your face from under the bridge, Latinos manning the bars, clubs lit up by ‘crazy live music’ performances, prostitutes trying to pry a lonely guy, artsy beggars, women from out of town looking for a hot story to tell their friends back home, ale-filled Irishmen, chicks wearing seductive transparent tape dresses, broken paper cups previously filled with whiskey manning the curb of 6th Street, policemen on horse-back trying to look Macho-Texan, local made bourbon on trucks, business executives making a loud scream to show their superiority, public toilets filled with adultery more than toiletries, responsible looking bicyclers, jealous looking mid-wives, drunk looking teenagers, vexed looking Uber drivers, hip looking DJ’s, youngsters sitting on street lamps and mailboxes, health freaks kayaking on the lake, marijuana dealers trying to sell another ‘package for you’, brides getting slutty, horny men chancing their luck, laser lights blaring out the city, execs laughing to a made-up joke, benevolent other-city people buying every-one a drink, chilled-beer sold from locally made joints, music to your heart’s content, stand-up comedians to your joyous vent, the opulent, the sparsers, the musicians, the guitarists, the young, the young-wannabe, the heavy